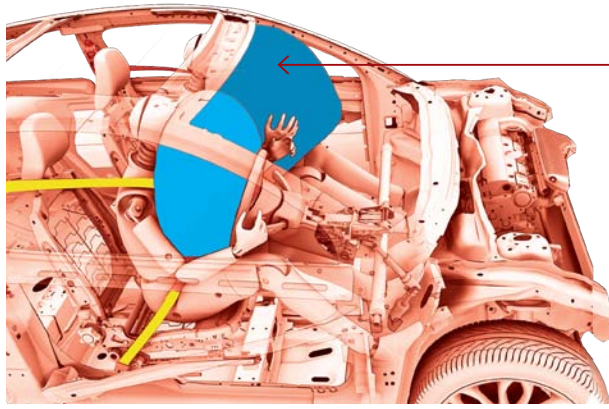


DO AIRBAGS GIVE ENOUGH PROTECTION?

Airbags are a 'supplementary' restraint system, with seat belts providing primary restraint. The SUV in which Mistry was travelling comes with seven airbags—for the driver, front passenger, driver knee, driver side and front-passenger side besides curtain airbags on the sides for rear passengers. As there are no front-facing airbags for those sitting in the rear, even if the curtain airbags open up, the passengers are likely to sustain severe injuries if they aren't buckled up.



55.9
PER CENT
Accidents caused by overspeeding (2021)

34
PER CENT
Of total accidents in 2019-21 took place on National Highways



HOW TO PREVENT DEATHS

Choose cars with more airbags: Cars with more airbags for the front and rear passengers can offer more protection and save lives, although they come at a higher price



Buckle up: Besides the driver, those sitting in the front and rear should always wear seat belts while travelling



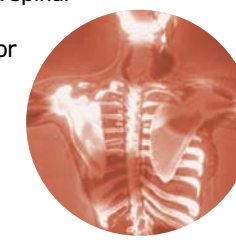
Store loose objects: Floating objects can become dangerous in a forceful collision; so it is important not to leave any loose objects in the car while it's moving



Control your speed: Nothing can be safer than having control over your vehicle, and that comes with limiting speed and doing routine car checkups

WHAT ARE THE COMMON INJURIES?

A car crash can lead to serious injuries of the chest, head, neck and spine. While head injuries are the most common, other injuries range from brain bleeds and bruised or fractured ribs to heart, lung and spinal damage. There could also be burns, scars or limb loss. Seat belts can prevent serious injuries and reduce the risk of death.



Sources for the figures: WHO's Global Status Report on Road Safety 2018 and NCRB's Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India Report 2021